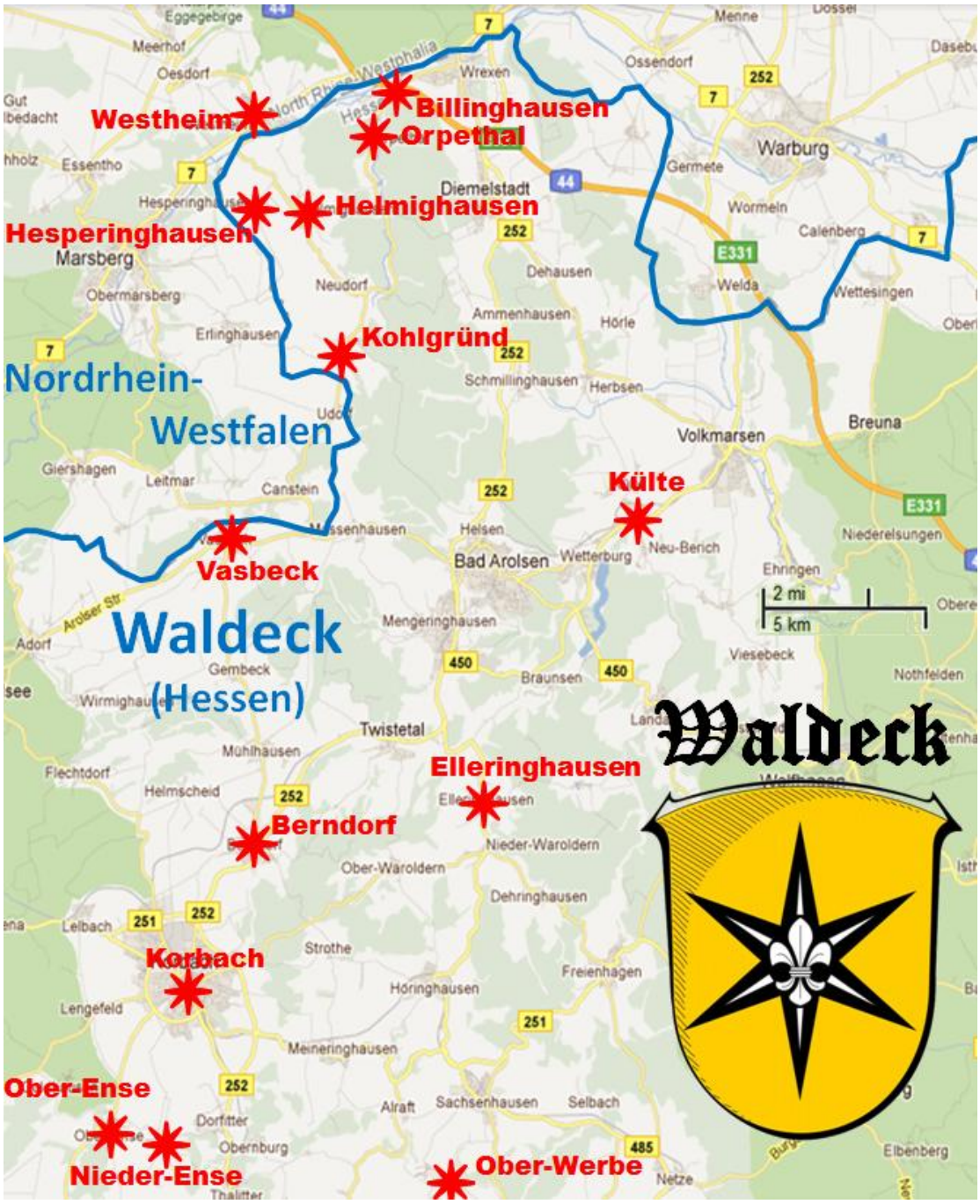
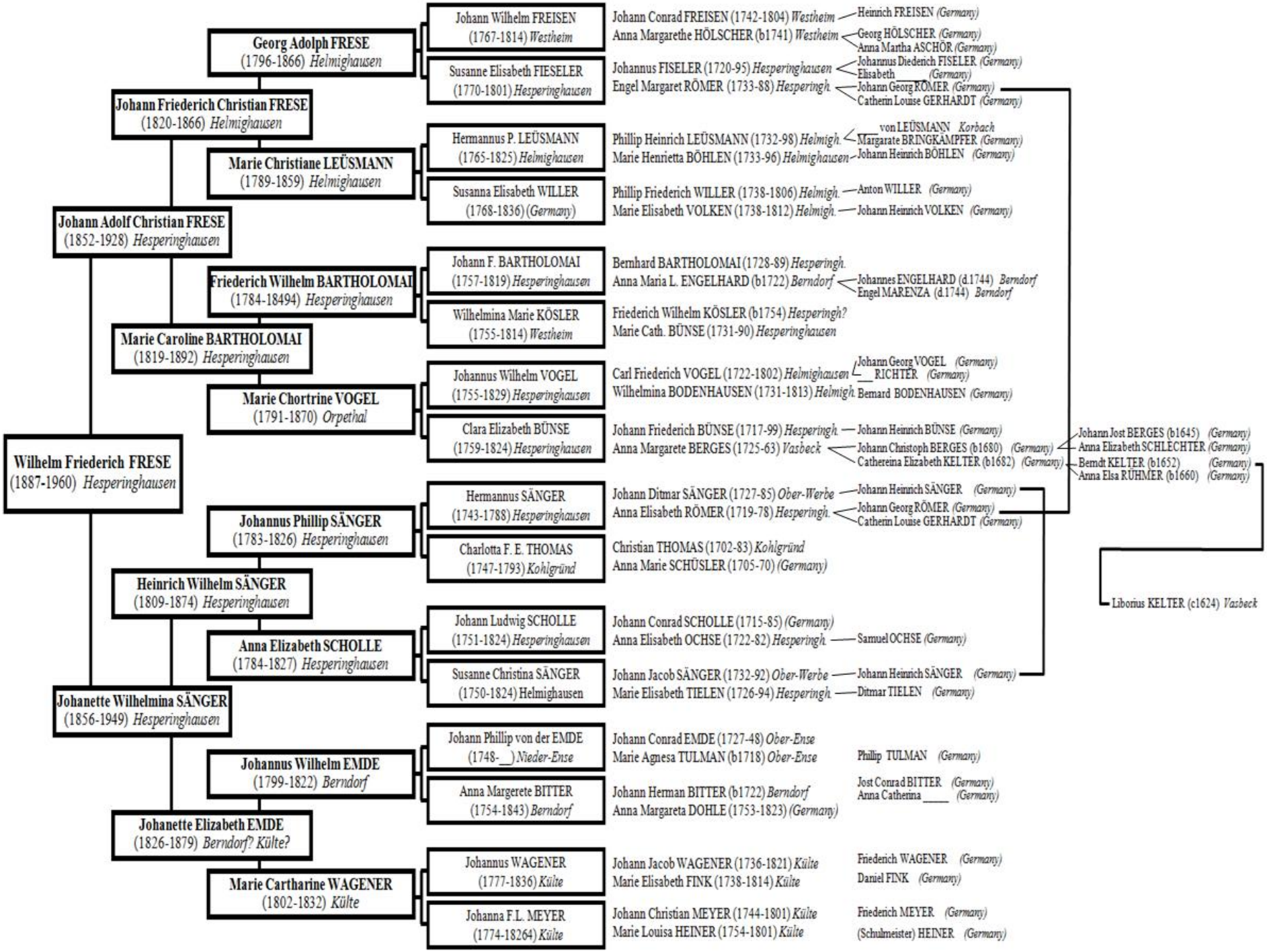
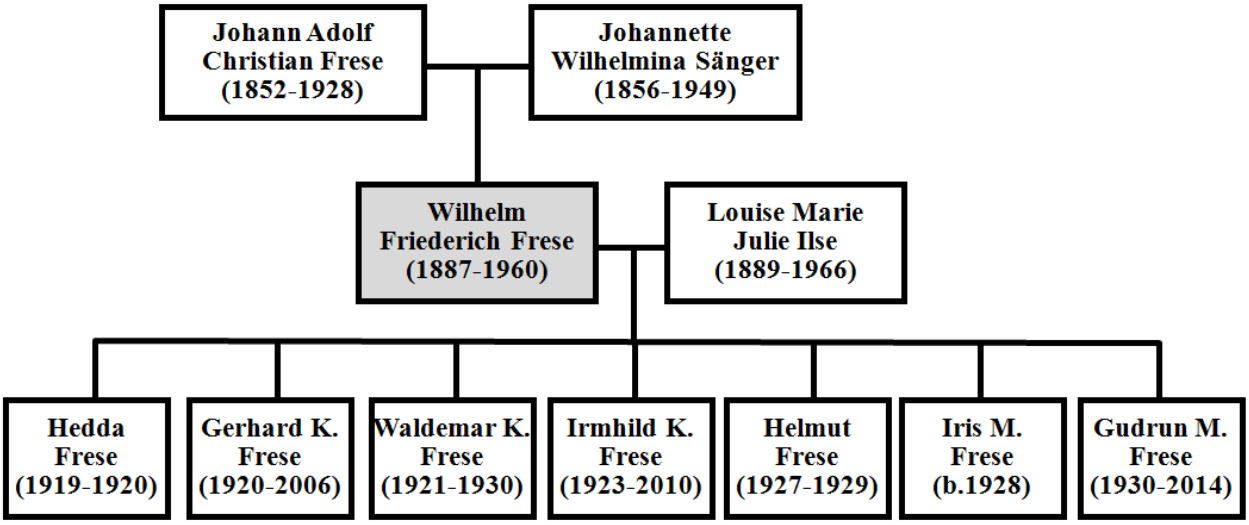
FRESES IN WALDECK



By Chris Mulholland

Updated 15 July 2014


Wilhelm Friederich FRESE (1887-1960) Hesperinghausen
Johann Adolf Christian FRESE (1852-1928) Hesperinghausen
Johann Friederich Christian FRESE (1820-1866) Helmighausen
Georg Adolph FRESE (1796-1866) Helmighausen
Johann Wilhelm FREISEN (1767-1814) Westheim
Johann Conrad FREISEN (1742-1804) Westheim
Heinrich FREISEN (Germany)
Anna Margarethe HÖLSCHER (b1741) Westheim
Georg HÖLSCHER (Germany)
Anna Martha ASCHÖR (Germany)
Susanne Elisabeth FIESELER (1770-1801) Hesperinghausen
Johannus FISELER (1720-95) Hesperinghausen
Johannus Diederich FISELER (Germany)
Elisabeth _____ (Germany)
Engel Margaret RÖMER (1733-88) Hesperingh.
Johann Georg RÖMER (Germany)
Catherin Louise GERHARDT (Germany)
Marie Christiane LEÜSMANN (1789-1859) Helmighausen
Hermannus P. LEÜSMANN (1765-1825) Helmighausen
Phillip Heinrich LEÜSMANN (1732-98) Helmigh.
___ von LEÜSMANN Korbach
Margarate BRINGKAMPFER (Germany)
Marie Henrietta BÖHLEN (1733-96) Helmighausen
Johann Heinrich BÖHLEN (Germany)
Susanna Elisabeth WILLER (1768-1836) (Germany)
Phillip Friederich WILLER (1738-1806) Helmigh.
Anton WILLER (Germany)
Marie Elisabeth VOLKEN (1738-1812) Helmigh.
Johann Heinrich VOLKEN (Germany)
Friederich Wilhelm BARTHOLOMAI (1784-18494) Hesperinghausen
Johann F. BARTHOLOMAI (1757-1819) Hesperinghausen
Bernhard BARTHOLOMAI (1728-89) Hesperingh.
Anna Maria L. ENGELHARD (b1722) Berndorf
Johannes ENGELHARD (d.1744) Berndorf
Engel MARENZA (d.1744) Berndorf
Wilhelmina Marie KÖSLER (1755-1814) Westheim
Friederich Wilhelm KÖSLER (b1754) Hesperingh?
Marie Cath. BÜNSE (1731-90) Hesperinghausen
Marie Caroline BARTHOLOMAI (1819-1892) Hesperinghausen
Marie Chortrine VOGEL (1791-1870) Orpethal
Johannus Wilhelm VOGEL (1755-1829) Hesperinghausen
Carl Friederich VOGEL (1722-1802) Helmighausen
Johann Georg VOGEL (Germany)
__ RICHTER (Germany)
Wilhelmina BODENHAUSEN (1731-1813) Helmigh.
Bernard BODENHAUSEN (Germany)
Clara Elizabeth BÜNSE (1759-1824) Hesperinghausen
Johann Friederich BÜNSE (1717-99) Hesperingh.
Johann Heinrich BÜNSE (Germany)
Anna Margarete BERGES (1725-63) Vasbeck
Johann Christoph BERGES (b1680) (Germany)
Cathereina Elizabeth KELTER (b1682) (Germany)
Johann Jost BERGES (b1645) (Germany)
Anna Elizabeth SCHLECHTER (Germany)
Berndt KELTER (b1652) (Germany)
Anna Elsa RÜHMER (b1660) (Germany)
Liborius KELTER (c1624) Vasbeck
Johannus Phillip SÄNGER (1783-1826) Hesperinghausen
Hermannus SÄNGER (1743-1788) Hesperinghausen
Johann Ditmar SÄNGER (1727-85) Ober-Werbe
Johann Heinrich SÄNGER (Germany)
Anna Elisabeth RÖMER (1719-78) Hesperingh.
Johann Georg RÖMER (Germany)
Catherin Louise GERHARDT (Germany)
Charlotta F. E. THOMAS (1747-1793) Kohlgründ
Christian THOMAS (1702-83) Kohlgründ
Anna Marie SCHÜSLER (1705-70) (Germany)
Heinrich Wilhelm SÄNGER (1809-1874) Hesperinghausen
Anna Elizabeth SCHOLLE (1784-1827) Hesperinghausen
Johann Ludwig SCHOLLE (1751-1824) Hesperinghausen
Johann Conrad SCHOLLE (1715-85) (Germany)
Anna Elisabeth OCHSE (1722-82) Hesperingh.
Samuel OCHSE (Germany)
Susanne Christina SÄNGER (1750-1824) Helmighausen
Johann Jacob SÄNGER (1732-92) Ober-Werbe
Johann Heinrich SÄNGER (Germany)
Marie Elisabeth TIELEN (1726-94) Hesperingh.
Ditmar TIELEN (Germany)
Johanette Wilhelmina SÄNGER (1856-1949) Hesperinghausen
Johannus Wilhelm EMDE (1799-1822) Berndorf
Johann Phillip von der EMDE (1748-__) Nieder-Ense
Johann Conrad EMDE (1727-48) Ober-Ense
Marie Agnesa TULMAN (b1718) Ober-Ense
Phillip TULMAN (Germany)
Anna Margerete BITTER (1754-1843) Berndorf
Johann Herman BITTER (b1722) Berndorf
Jost Conrad BITTER (Germany)
Anna Catherina ____ (Germany)
Anna Margareta DOHLE (1753-1823) (Germany)
Johanette Elizabeth EMDE (1826-1879) Berndorf? Külte?
Marie Cartharine WAGENER (1802-1832) Külte
Johannus WAGENER (1777-1836) Külte
Johann Jacob WAGENER (1736-1821) Külte
Friederich WAGENER (Germany)
Marie Elisabeth FINK (1738-1814) Külte
Daniel FINK (Germany)
Johanna F.L. MEYER (1774-18264) Külte
Johann Christian MEYER (1744-1801) Külte
Friederich MEYER (Germany)
Marie Louisa HEINER (1754-1801) Külte
(Schulmeister) HEINER (Germany)


Johann Adolf Christian Frese (1852-1928)
Johannette Wilhelmina Sänger (1856-1949)
Wilhelm Friederich Frese (1887-1960)
Louise Marie Julie Ilse (1889-1966)
Hedda Frese (1919-1920)
Gerhard K. Frese (1920-2006)
Waldemar K. Frese (1921-1930)
Irmhild K. Frese (1923-2010)
Helmut Frese (1927-1929)
Iris M. Frese (b.1928)
Gudrun M. Frese (1930-2014)

FRESES IN WALDECK

Cold, wet, and hungry, his home and farm destroyed by a winter flood, the first Frese took what was left of his family and fled from his ancestral homeland along the North Sea coast in the mid 1600s. Following a series of disasters during the previous years, he had had enough and was leaving for a better life. A plague and several monster winter storms had finally convinced him that it was time to move to higher – and safer – ground. As he sailed upriver and deeper into the heart of Germany, instead of finding the 'promised land', he and his family passed through a landscape of devastated farms and villages which had been denuded through a series of plagues, wars, and plundering bands of renegade soldiers and bandits. After days and weeks of sailing, he finally found a less troubled area and declared that this would be where his family would start a new life. And here is where the story of the Freses in Waldeck begins.

The family name began as "Freisen" and eventually turned into "Frese" . It originates from the family's roots in "Friesland" and the Fresian Islands (also spelled "Friesian" or "Frisian"), which lie along the coast line of Germany about 400 km to the North of Waldeck. Even today, people are frequently referred to by their origin. For example, a family has lived in the small village of Hesperinghausen since 1970 yet they are still referred to as the "*Ausländer*" (Outlanders) because they came from somewhere else in Germany.

The Fresian Islands run along the North Sea coastline of Germany from Holland to Denmark, rising only a few feet above the water. Between the mainland and the islands lie wide expanses of tidal mud flats called "*Wattenmeer*" (mud-flat sea). The

islands are protected by a large system of dikes and sand dunes which have been built and rebuilt over the centuries. An old Frisian proverb says, "*de nick will diken, de mid wiken*" ("Who will not build a dike, shall lose ground.")

Not surprisingly, many Frisian legends and folk songs tell of drowned villages. The German and Dutch governments have spent large sums not only to protect their seaward coasts but also to reclaim the land from the "watten" (mud) for farming. Fishing, the raising of sheep and cattle, and the cultivation of rye, oat, and potatoes are the main occupations in most islands; while the sandy beaches and resorts attract many tourists.

There are three distinct groups of islands, one in Holland (the West Frisian Islands) and two in Germany: the "*Ostfriesische Inseln*" (Eastern Frisian Islands) also known as East Friesland, between the Dutch border and the Elbe river mouth; and the "*Nordfriesische Inseln*" (North Frisian Islands) or North Friesland, along the Jutland Peninsula and the Schleswig-Holstein coast.

The first mention of the Frisians, "Frisii", was made by Roman historians Pliny the Elder and Tacitus in the first century. In Pliny's "*Historia Naturalis*" (Natural History), he states that the Frisians were conquered by the Roman general Drusus in 12 BC. These Frisians were related by both speech and blood to the other Germanic tribes of Saxons and Angles. Thereafter the Frisians largely sank into historical obscurity, until coming into contact with the expanding Merovingian and Carolingian empires. In the 5th century, during this period of historical silence, many of them no doubt joined the migration of the

Anglo-Saxons who went through Frisian territory to invade Britain, while those who stayed on the continent expanded into the newly-emptied lands previously occupied by the Anglo-Saxons. By the end of the sixth century the Frisians occupied the coast all the way to the mouth of the Weser and spread farther still in the seventh century, southward down to Dorestad and even Bruges. This farthest extent of Frisian territory is known as Frisia Magna.

When conditions improved Frisia would receive an influx of new settlers, mostly Angles and Saxons and these would eventually be referred to as 'Frisians', though they were not necessarily descended from the ancient Frisii. It is these 'new Frisians' who are largely the ancestors of the medieval and modern Frisians

In the 9th century, the North Frisian Islands were likely overrun by Scandinavian pirates. Family lore says that the original Freses were Vikings (called Normans along the French coastline) who had been stranded on the islands when their ships were wrecked on the treacherous shoals. They supposedly made their living by lighting large bonfires and drawing other mariners unto the shoals and then scavenging the wreckage as it washed ashore.

The 1600s were a time of terrible calamities for the Frisians. In 1603, bubonic plague dramatically diminished the population and was followed by two major storms over the next decades that almost totally denuded the area. Another family story says that our Freses left the islands in the 1600s after a massive storm wiped out their farms and killed numerous people. It was probably one of two major storms that each killed more than 15,000; the severe winter storm of 11-12 October

1634, known as the "*Burchardi Flood*", or the storm of 22 February 1651, "*St. Peter's Flood*". The year 1651 was an '*annus horribilis*' (horrible year) for Europe as there were many disastrous floods.

The Frisian languages are still used by 500,000 speakers and dialects of Frisian are recognized as official languages in both the Netherlands and Germany.

The East Frisian Islands consist of seven inhabited islands – Borkum, Juist, Nordernev, Baltrum, Langeoog, Spiekeroog, and Wangerooge – as well as four smaller, uninhabited ones – Lütje Hörn, Memmert, Kachelotplate, Minsener Oog, and Mellum.

North Friesland consists of five larger islands – Sylt, Föhr, Amrum, Nordstrand and Pellworm – and ten tiny islets, which are called "*Halligen*". The houses on these tiny islets are built on artificial hills and, in a storm tide, only these hills rise above the sea while the remaining islet is flooded. Until 1634 the islands of Nordstrand, Nordstrandischmoor, and Pellworm were part of one large island.

In just a few hours of the storm of 1634, "the flood accompanying this storm, swept away complete villages, hamlets and even islands from the face of the earth. About 15,000 people lost their lives that disastrous night, a pivotal event in human history within this region and beyond. Nordstrand Island – where more than 6,000 people drowned – suffered the most devastation… At Eiderstedt, the area south of Nordstrand Island, 2,106 people drowned, despite being protected by dikes 18-20 feet high. Inside Klixbüll's church, people marked the water level on the wall: 14 feet above ground level… As the water withdrew from the fields, the salt stayed

behind and made the fields useless. The results of the flood were disastrous for the economy of the entire North Frisian coast. All these aspects and the traumatic experiences of the flood paralyzed the spirit of enterprise of most survivors. Many moved away…" ["*Cor Snabel's story of the Nordstrand flood of 1634*"]

The flood had a devastating effect on the island of Nordstrand, which suffered the most. The island, which was sometimes just called "Strand", was about one hundred square miles in size and had less than 8500 inhabitants. The storm's

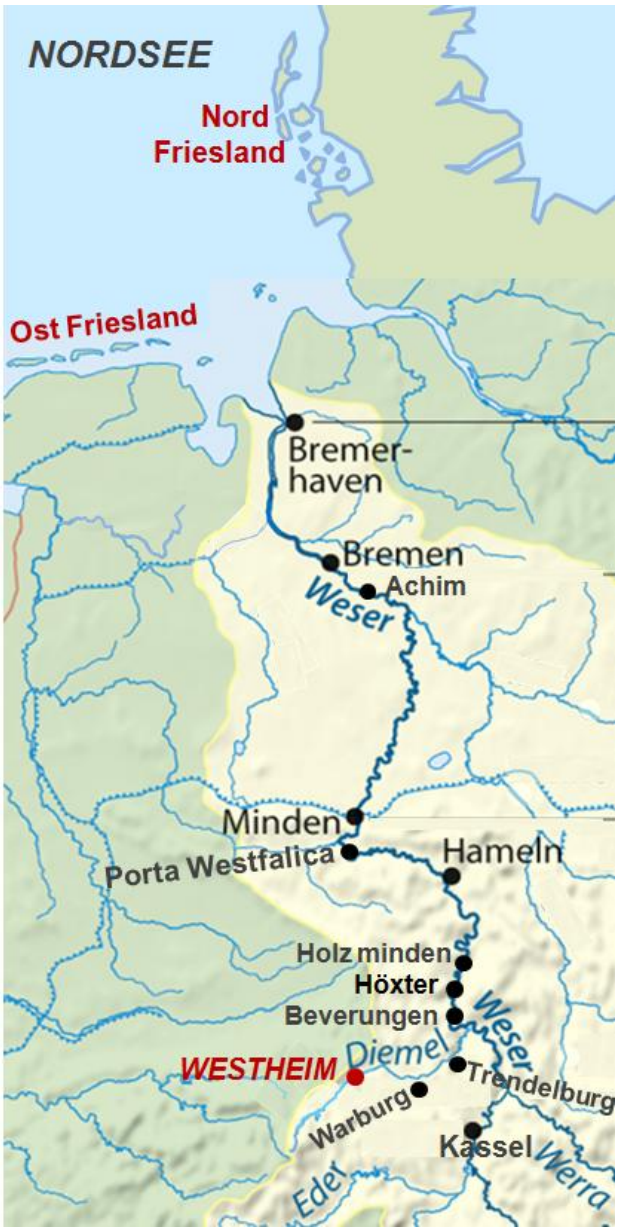
flood tide swallowed more than half of the island. A total of 6123 people drowned, and 1339 farms and houses were washed away, as were 28 windmills and 6 clock towers. The estimated loss of livestock was 50,000.

A Dutch hydraulic engineer, Jan Adriaansz Leeghwater, living in Nordstrand during the storm later wrote, "Big sea ships were stranded on high dikes, as I have seen myself. Several ships were stranded in the higher streets of Husum [Nordstrand's largest town]. I've been on the beaches, where I have seen horrible things. Countless dead bodies of people and animals, along with beams of houses, smashed wagons and lots of wood, straw and rubbish. It was like the Flood had been here."

FRESES IN WALDECK

After surviving one of these two devastations, and maybe both, our early Freses abandoned their homeland and traveled inland to 'higher, safer ground'. The Freses who settled in in northern Waldeck moved south to the mouth of the Weser River near Bremerhaven before sailing

upriver. Expecting the best, they found the worst because they sailed directly into the maelstrom of the Thirty Years' War (1618-1648) and the long lasting effects of the man-made devastation shortly thereafter.



The war involved most countries in Europe and was one of the most destructive conflicts in European history until World War I. Initially fought as a religious conflict between Protestants and Catholics in the Holy Roman Empire it gradually developed into a more general conflict involving most of the European powers. If the Freses sailed up the Weser in late 1634 or early 1635 they were entering an area that had recently been conquered by Swedish forces.

In any case, the first city the Freses

arrived at was Bremen. Historically, the region around the city had been captured from the Saxons in the 9th century by the West Germanic Franks led by King Charlemage, also known as "*Karl der Große*" (Charles the Great), who was also crowned as the first emperor of the Holy Roman Empire. After his victory, Charlemagne issued a new law, the Lex Saxonum, which prohibited Saxons from worshiping Odin and ordered them to convert to Christianity upon pain of death.

After leaving Bremen, the Freses continued sailing southwards on the Weser and passed a number of other historic cities and towns: Achim, meeting place of the old Saxon courts; Minden, first settled in the 3rd century; Hameln, famous as the location for the medieval story of "*Der Rattenfänger von Hameln*" *(* the Pied Piper of Hameln); Holzminden, which was completely destroyed by fighting in 1640; Höxter, which had been the scene for a famous battle between Charlemagne and the Saxons; and Beverungen, which suffered the plague in 1626 and was almost completely burned down in 1632, leaving only 5 houses standing afterwards.

A 1592 illustration of "*Der Rattenfänger von Hameln*"

After passing Minden, the Freses sailed through the "*Porta Westfalica*" (Westphalian Gate), a gorge and water gap, where the

Weser River runs through a passage between the mountain chains of the Wiehengebirge to the west and the Wesergebirge to the east.

Not long after Porta Westfalica, the Freses arrived at the juncture of the Weser and Diemel rivers and the "*Kloster Helmarshausen*" (Helmarshausen Abbey) founded nearby in 997 AD. Here, the Diemel flows into the Weser from the west after originating in the rolling hills of the "*Sauerland*", a rural, hilly, heavily-forested area which spreads across most of the south-eastern part of "*Nordrhein-Westfalen*" (Northern Rhine-Westphalia) and is, apart from the major valleys, sparsely inhabited. Sauerland has recently been used for the reintroduction of the Wisent (or European bison). Northeastern Sauerland consists of the Teutoburg Forest where Germanic tribes destroyed three Roman Legions in 9 AD.

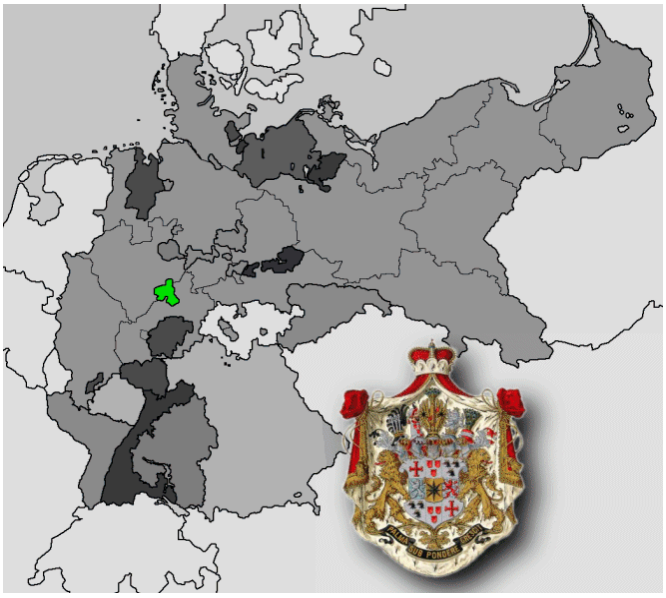
The name "*Sauerland"* is first mentioned as "*Suderland"* (southern country) in an official document from 1266. After 1400 the letter '*d*' began to disappear. Therefore the most convincing meaning for Sauerland is southern country, as opposed to the theory that Sauer is from the German word "*sauer"* meaning *sour* for the poor, or 'sour', soil. Linguistically, "suder-" is similar to the Old Saxon "*sûðar"* (southbound).

After arriving at the junction of the two rivers, the Freses turned right and sailed westwards up the Diemel passing by Trendelburg and Warburg before arriving at the small town of Westheim located on the north bank. Located in the state of Nordrhein-Westfalen, Westheim lies in "*Hochsauerland*" (high Sauerland)

Trendelburg, 1655

and over the years has been under various administrations including the Kingdom of Prussia as part of "*Provinz Westfalen*" (Province of Westphalia). Just across the river to the south, lay the Principality of Waldeck and a few miles inland, the two small villages of Hesperinghausen and Helmighausen which would play a large part in the family history.

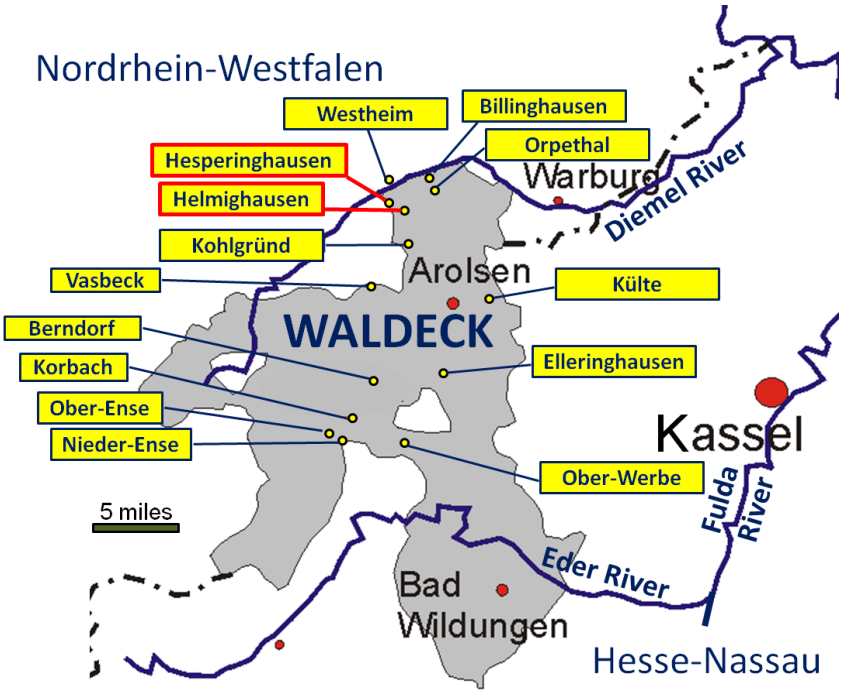
Waldeck had been a county within the Holy Roman Empire since about 1200. In 1655, the seat and chief residence of its rulers shifted from the castle and small town of Waldeck, overlooking the Eder River and first mentioned in 1120, to Arolsen, only seven miles from Hesperinghausen. In 1625 the small county of Pyrmont (many miles to the north) became part of the county through inheritance and, in January 1712, the count of Waldeck and Pyrmont was elevated to prince by Charles VI, Holy Roman Emperor. The princely house of Waldeck and Pyrmont is closely related to the royal family of the Netherlands as the last ruling prince, Frederick (1865-1946), was the brother of Dutch Queen Consort Emma (1858-1934) and uncle of Queen Wilhelmina (1880-1962) of the Kingdom of the Netherlands.



The Principality of Waldeck (green) and the Waldeck Coat of Arms

The Principality of Waldeck-Pyrmont was one of the smaller states of the "*Deutscher Bund*" (German Confederation). Most of the citizens lived quietly in the numerous small villages nestled in rolling countryside. Waldeck is now an administrative District (about 420 sq mi/1,090 sq km) of Hesse. Arolsen was the capital. An agricultural

region, hilly and forested, it is drained by the Eder and Diemel rivers. In 1867 the prince of Waldeck-Pyrmont renounced most of his sovereign prerogatives in favor of Prussia; the title, however, continued in the family. Waldeck-Pyrmont became a republic in 1918. By a plebiscite in 1922, Pyrmont passed to Prussia and was incorporated into Hanover prov.; by another plebiscite (1929) Waldeck proper became part of the Hesse-Nassau province of Prussia. After World War II it was incorporated into Hesse and in 1972 the two districts of Frankenberg and Waldeck were merged and renamed Waldeck-Frankenberg. The new "*Kreis*" (district) consists mostly of what was previously part of the "*Freistaat Waldeck*" (Free State of Waldeck).



The first recorded Frese in the family tree is Heinrich Freisen, whose son, Johann Conrad Freisen (1742-1804), was born in Westheim. Heinrich was probably also born in Westheim between 1700 and 1720. His father, in turn, would have been born between 1660 and 1700 and may have been among the first generation of Freses born in the Sauerland.

Johann married Anna Margarethe Hölscher on 3 May 1767 in Westheim and they had a son, Johann Wilhelm Freisen on 30 September 1767. Johann Wilhelm would fall in love with Susanne Elisabeth Fiseler (1770-1801) from Hesperinghausen, less than two miles south of Westheim. They were married on 18 November 1791 and at one point lived in Helmighausen, one mile east of

Hesperinghausen (view from the north)

Hesperinghausen – their son Georg Adolph Frese was born there on 3 June 1796. Susanne died in 1801 and Johann then moved to Billinghausen, on the south bank of the Diemel three miles east of Westheim, and died there in 1814.

Susanne Elisabeth Fiseler's parents were Johannus Fiseler (1720-1795) and Engel Margareta Römer (1733-1788) both of whom were born, raised, and died in Hesperinghausen. Susanne's grandfather was Johann Georg Römer and her mother may have had two brothers or cousins who served with the British Army during the

American Revolutionary War (1776-1783). In his book, "*Waldeck Soldiers of the American Revolutionary War*", Bruce E. Burgoyne lists two "Roemers" from Hesperinghausen; Christoph (born 1749) and Friederich (1757). The likelihood that there's a connection to our family's Römers is extremely high.

During the American Revolution, many Hessians served with the English Army in America as "hired" soldiers. Six German Principalities sent troops to the Americas for service in the American Revolution. The total number of German troops from all the States who were sent was approximately 29,875, with 12,562 never to return to Europe due to death or desertion. It is interesting to note that the treaties with the German States for troops was one of the factors which fomented the Declaration of Independence to be signed in the colonies.

Both of the Römers sailed to America in 1776 with the 3rd Waldeck Regiment – Christoph as a corporal in the 1st Company and Friederich as a private in the 3rd Company. Christoph had 10 years of previous military experience with the 1st Waldeck Regiment and was captured at Baton Rouge, Louisiana on 21 September 1779. He deserted from prisoner status at Havana, Cuba on 31 March 1782 and later rejoined his unit in December of 1782, as a private. He eventually deserted his unit entirely at Flatbush, New York on 2 July 1783.

Friederich stood five foot three inches tall and was taken prisoner at Springfield, New Jersey, on 5 January 1777. He was then sent to Philadelphia, Pennsylvania for an exchange of prisoners on 18 June 1778 before apparently returning to Germany with the regiment in 1783.

FRESES IN WALDECK

Ironically enough, the Römers with the British and Hessians might have met one of the Mulholland ancestors with the American colonists (a Joslyn/ Joslin/ Jossilyn, Chapin, Clough, Davison, or Child) somewhere on a Revolutionary War battlefield.

Johann and Susanne (Fieseler) Freisen's son, Georg Adolph (1796-1866), was the first to use the name Frese. On 25 May 1823, he married Marie Christiane Leüsmann whose extended family had lived in a Helmighausen for several generations (back at least to 1600).

Helmighausen sits near the border with Westphalia and probably never consisted of anything more than 1000 residents, even today, there are less than 500. One mile uphill to the west lies its larger sister village, Hesperinghausen. For centuries the predominant industries in both were agriculture and dairy cows although the area around them was the private hunting ground for the royal family of Waldeck. Hesperinghausen is said to have been named for the fresh water spring located in the middle of

The "Fresehaus" (spring to right)

the village which was important to the deer and other game that the royal hunters pursued: "*Hirsch Spring*" ("deer spring"). The well is still present and located directly behind the old "*Fresehaus*" in the center of the village although interestingly, Hesperinghausen sits on an elevated piece of ground.

Hesperinghausen welcome sign

The two villages of Hesperinghausen and Helmighausen are linked closely together through numerous family associations and history. The latter can trace its history back the farthest since it has the more complete records. In 1993 it celebrated its 950th anniversary (1043 AD.) Hesperinghausen was probably established around the same time as Helmighausen but - probably due to the turmoil of the 30 years' war (1618-1648) - their records only go back 740 years (to 1225 AD) because they were partially destroyed during the Thirty Years War.

The villages also alternate the "*Schützenfest*" ("Marksmen's Festival") with Hesperinghausen holding theirs in the even years and Helmighausen in the odd ones. Over the centuries, many villages

throughout Germany had to find ways of defending themselves from gangs of marauding soldiers and robbers. Clubs and associations, comparable to militias, were founded and eventually sanctioned in the "*Law for the Defensive Constitution of the Towns"* by King "*Heinrich der Vogler*" (Henry I, the Fowler, 876-936). Accompanying the military exercises and physical examinations of the towns' contingents, festivities were held along with parades and celebrations. At the Schützenfest, the men of the village shoot at a wooden eagle. Until the start of the Second World War carbine rifles were used in the competition, however, after the war and the demilitarization of Germany when the possession of shooting arms was discouraged, Hesperinghausen began using a large "*armbrust*" (crossbow) in their competitions. In the late 1990s, the original flags from the mid 1800s were found in a trunk in Helmighausen where they had been hidden since WWII. One side of one flag reads, "*Mit Gott für Kaiser und Reich*" (with God for Emperor and Empire).

The male children also compete in their own competition, throwing weighted sticks to knock down a wooden eagle mounted at a lower height. Interestingly enough, the weighted sticks are shaped very closely to the old "potato masher" hand-grenades used by German soldiers in both world wars.

There are three different winners who hold their titles until the following biannual competition: the winner of the married men becomes the "*Schützenkönig*" (Shooting

King); the bachelor winner becomes the "*Vizekönige*" (Viceroy); and the boy winner becomes the "*Schützenkinderkönig*" (Shooting Child King). In 1966, Chris Mulholland (b.1958), Wilhelm Friederich Frese's grandson, won the title of Hesperinghausen's "*Schützenkinderkönig*" and his "*Kinderkönigin*" was Irmhild Slotosch.

Chris Mulholland (rt) and Irmhild Slotosch with their "court" in 1966

On 10 November 1820, Georg and Marie (Leüsmann) Frese had a son, Johann Friederich Christian Frese, who married Marie Caroline Bartholomai (1819-1892) on 27 April 1850. Marie's parents, Friederich Wilhelm Bartholomai (1784-1894) and Marie Chortrine Vogel (1791-1870) had extensive family ties to Hesperinghausen. Marie's grandfather, Johannus Wilhelm Vogel (1755-1829), hailed from Helmighausen and his parents, Carl Friederich Vogel (1722-1802) and Wilhelmina Maria Frederica Bodenhausen (1731-1813), still have many descendants living there. Marie's fraternal grandmother, Anna Maria Lisabetha Engelhard (1722-1789), was born in Berndorf, a town 12 miles south of Hesperinghausen.

Marie Chortrine Vogel's mother, Clara Elizabeth Bünse (1759-1824), was said to be related to Robert Wilhelm Eberhard Bunsen (1811-1899), the chemist who developed the Bunsen Burner, a piece of equipment that produces a single open gas flame and is found in laboratories around the world. Marie also had familial

ties to the town ofVasbeck, a few miles southeast of Hesperinghausen, through her maternal grandmother, Anna Margarete Berges (1725-1763), going back five generations to Liborius Kelter who was born there about 1624.

Johann Friederich Christian and Marie Caroline (Bartholomai) Frese had a son, Johann Adolf Christian, on 10 May 1852, in Hesperinghausen. In 1878, two days after Christmas, Johann Adolf married Johanette Wilhelmina Sänger (1856-1949) . Johann and Johanette were fourth cousins since they both had the same great-great-great-grandparents, Johann Georg and Catherin Louise Römer.

Johann Adolf and Johanette (Sänger) Frese

Johanette Wilhelmina‘s fraternal grandparents were second cousins, Johannus Phillip Sänger (1809-1874) and Anna Elizabeth Scholle (1784-1827), who married in Hesperinghausen in 1808. Although Johanette‘s family had a long history in Hesperinghausen she also had many ties to towns and villages in southern Waldeck through her mother Johanette Elizabeth Emde (1826-1879). These places included Külte, Ober-Ense, Ober-Werbe, Kohlgründ, Nieder-Ense, and Berndorf.

Hesperinghausen Kirche (Church)

Undoubtedly, all of the weddings, baptisms, and funeral ceremonies that took place in Hesperinghausen were held in the "*Kirche*" (church) that still stands there. Many years after having left the village and making a successful career as a Lutheran "*Pfarrer*" (pastor) in Berlin and Dresden, Wilhelm Friederich

Frese (1887-1960) retired and moved back to his home village where he opened the church on Sundays and ministered to his friends and family.

Pfarrer Wilhelm Friederich Frese

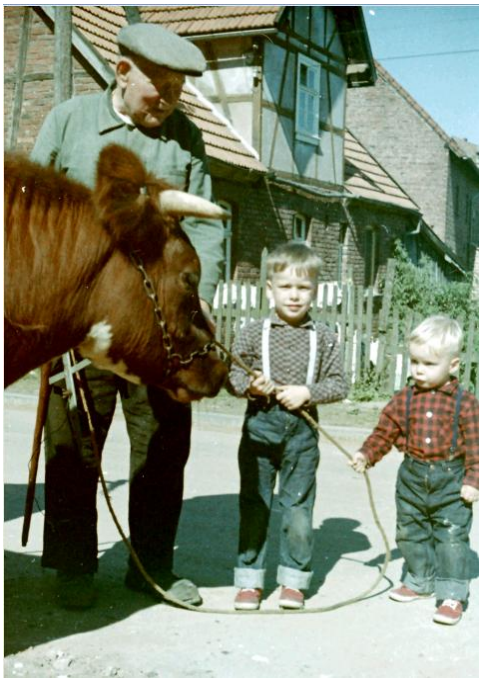
A large number of Germans emigrated to the United States during the mid 19th century, including many from Waldeck, some of them Freses. During the 1950s, Pastor Frese traveled to America and met one of those distant relatives.

In 1935, the National Socialist Party (Nazis) passed the Nuremberg Laws which stated that, "A citizen of the Reich is only that subject who is of German or kindred blood, and, who through his conduct, shows that he is both desirous and fit to serve faithfully the German people and Reich." With the widespread fear of being accused of having "racially alien blood", many Germans researched their family histories in order to acquire the documentation proving their "Germanhood". One of those researchers was young Gerhard Karl Frese (1920-2006), son of Pfarrer Frese, who collected a great deal of information about the family that has been handed down and was used to write this history. Most – if not all – of these extended Frese families, the Leüsmanns, Bartholomais, Vogels, Sängers, Scholles, Emdes, Römers, Fieselers, Hölschers, Kelters, Engelhards, Bünses, Bodenhausens, and others like the Willers, Aschörs, Bringkampfers, Böhlens, Volkens, Köslers, Berges', Thomas', Schüslers, Ochses, Tielens, Tulmans, Bitters, Dohles,

Gerhard Karl Frese

Wageners, Finks, Meyers, and Heiners, were simple "*Bauern*" (farmers), living peaceful and idyllic lives in Waldeck. In all of these records, there was only one person who was noted to have a different occupation and that was the father of Marie Louisa Heiner (1754-1801) who was listed as a "*Schulmeister*" (schoolteacher) .

The farmers in Waldeck lived together in villages and walked their livestock out to the fields in the surrounding countryside. This arrangement had come about in response to the Thirty Years War when farmers banded together in order to protect themselves, their families, and their livestock from the marauding mercenaries of the foreign armies. Some of the older homes in Hesperinghausen and Helmighausen consist of the family living



Chris (ctr) and Max (rt) Mulholland about 1963 – Fresehaus in background

quarters and the animal barn under the same roof. However, fewer and fewer villagers still remain farmers, most of them now commute to the cities for work.

Over the centuries, children in Germany were typically named after the ruling kings, queens, princes, princesses, and members of the royal families. The historical records of Hesperinghausen and Helmighausen are replete with Friederichs, Carolines, Wilhelms, Wilhelminas, Johanns and Johannettes.

The area where the Freses settled is now surrounded by three large "*Naturparks*" (nature parks): to the north, *Teutoburger Wald / Eggegebirge*; to the east, *Habichtswald*; and to the west, *Diemelsee*.

Teutoburger Wald has many cultural and historical associations, and is primarily known for the famous battle between the Romans under Varus and the Cheruscans led by Arminus (or Hermann). In 9 A.D. the Germanic tribe utterly destroyed three Roman legions and put an end to Roman rule east of the Rhine. Suetonius, in his "*Lives of the Twelve Caesars"*, wrote that Emperor Augustus banged his head against the palace walls, crying "*Quintili Vare, legions redde!"* ("Quintilius Varus, give me back my legions!") A 54 metre high monument to Hermann stands near Detmold in Germany to commemorate the victory. More battles between Rome and the German tribes continued in the years that followed, but as a result of Teutoburg the Rhine was firmly established as the northernmost boundary of Roman expansion. Therefore, northern Germany and Scandinavia remained free from the influence of Roman culture and Roman law.

FRESES IN WALDECK

The ancient Germans had a highly decentralized form of government, with laws based on custom and administered by a local council (witan) composed of free men who served both as a lawmaking body and as a jury for civil and criminal cases. This form of government was later brought to England and was highlighted by the Magna Charter of 1215 which was written in response to the form of Roman law brought over by the Normans in 1066. So today, Hermann the Liberator is not only lauded for preserving the freedom of northern Germany and Scandinavia, he is also recognized for having made possible the transmission of the common law to England and eventually to America.

Another park, *Habichtswald* ("Hawk Forest"), lies just to the east-southeast of Hesperinghausen and was inhabited as long as 5,000 years ago by the Chatti tribe whose name derives from the medieval "*Hassi*", now today's "*Hesse*". The forest also includes numerous Stone and Bronze age settlements with burial chambers and rock formations as well as medieval castles and fortifications.

To the west-southwest lies the Diemelsee Nature Park which has the highest mountains of the Sauerland, and consists of wide valleys and deep forests alternating with meadows and pastures. In the large, contiguous areas of forest are red deer, wild boar, roe deer and the elusive mouflon – a form of wild sheep. Near Korbach is the mountain of Eisenberg which at one time was Germany's

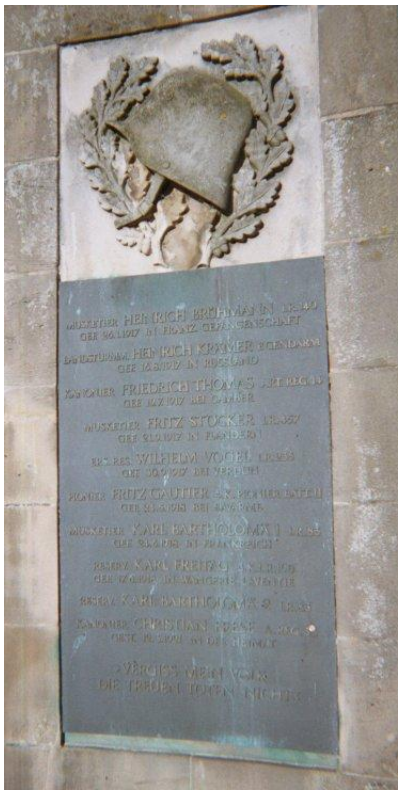
largest gold deposit with mining starting in the 11th century and ceasing around 1617 when the deposit was exhausted.

Several miles south of the villages lies the *Edersee*, Germany's third largest reservoir, which was created through the construction of the Eder Dam in 1914. The dam helped regulate water levels for shipping along the Weser and generated hydroelectricity. On 17 May 1943 it was destroyed by the British air force using a "skip bomb", causing massive flooding and loss of life downstream, but it was quickly rebuilt. On a mountain top high above the reservoir sits *Waldeck Schloss* (castle).

Arolsen, the largest city in Waldeck, lies between the Edersee and Hesperinghausen and was the home of the ruling Princes of Waldeck-Pyrmont and until 1929 was the capital of the Waldeck Free State. The earliest documents mentioning Arolsen date back to 1131 when an Augustinian nunnery was established there with the name of "Aroldessen". The city's main attraction is the baroque Schloss Arolsen which is still open for tours.

FRESES IN WALDECK

The last Frese to live in Hesperinghausen was Pfarrer Wilhelm Frese (1887-1960) who returned to his home village in the late 1950s and died in 1960. His wife, Louise Marie (Ilse) continued living there until her death in 1966. Their home, the "*Fresehaus*", was then sold by their son, Gerd, living in Augsburg.



Wilhelm and his two younger brothers, Friederich "Fritz" Wilhelm (1893-1915) and Christian Albert (1896-1921), were drafted and served on the Western Front of World War I; Wilhelm as an infantryman, Fritz as a "pioneer" or combat engineer, and Christian as an artilleryman. Fritz was killed at the Battle of Loretto Heights ("*Lorettohöhe*") in France in June 1915 and Christian died in 1921 in Germany, probably as a result of wounds he had received during the war. Fritz and Christian's names are listed on a monument to the WWI dead from Hesperinghausen.

Wilhelm and Louise (Ilse) Frese

Wilhelm's oldest brother, Karl Friederich, lived as a farmer in Hesperinghausen all his life and died there in 1956.

Karl Frese (right)

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